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Herbal remedies by tribals and herbal practitioners of Ranchi district of Jharkhand for treatment of skin disease

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Abstract : At present skin disease become a widely spread disease and is increasing day by day in our country as well as at global level. Thousands of people are suffering from various types of skin problems and diseases. The reason for all these are climatic changes , life style of people, radiation effects, different types of pollution, use of different types of pesticides, insecticides, herbicides, side effects of synthetic drugs etc.This paper deals with some medicinal plants which are used by herbal healers (practitioners) in villages in treating skin disease in Jharkhand state of India. Some plant species reported along with mode of administrations.

Key Words: Skin disease, Traditional plants, Herbal healers etc.

INTRODUCTION

Ethan botany is the study of direct relationship between man and plants. Plants since time immemorial have been used virtually in all the cultures as a source of medicine. The traditional use of herbal plants for health care described in Vedas and Bible also.

According to WHO as many as 80% of world population depend upon traditional medicine for their primary healthcare needs[1].The traditional system of medicine are very effective particularly in rural areas of India for the treatment of problems[2].India is one of the 12 mega diversity countries.

At present thousands of people are suffering from various types of skin diseases which is increasing day by day[3].For this a number of factors are responsible like climatic changes, life style of people, radiation effects, different types of pollution, use of different types of pesticides, insecticides, herbicides, side effects of synthetic drugs etc.

Large number of plants/ plant parts, their extracts, pastes etc. are used for curing skin disease by the tribals and local healers[4].The number of traditional healers are on decline because the younger members of tribes shifting towards towns and cities and changing their profession[5,6]. There is a danger that the knowledge of these medicinal plants will also die.

Location of Ranchi district in Jharkhand

Study area—The area under investigation for ethno medical studies (figure-1) falls under district RANCHI ,in state JHARKHAND, INDIA. Ranchi is located in the southern part ofchotanagpur. Which is the eastern section of the Deccan plateau?Ranchi lies at 23°21' N 85°20'E.It's averageelevation is 651m above sea level. Summer temperature range from 20° to 42°C and winter temperature from 0° to 25°C.The annual rainfall is about 1430 mm (56.34 inches). Ranchi has a humid subtropical climate ("Cfa"). Ranchi has a hillytopography having dense tropical forest.

MATERIALS AND METHODS

Author have conducted an extensive field survey in the tribal belt in different villages in Ranchi district

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of Jharkhand. During the study trips information was gathered byinterviewing the medicinal man(local healers, vaidyas). Identification and Confirmation of plants done by consulting those people . All the specimens are confirmed with the help of floristic literatures in Dept. of Botany , Ranchi collage,Ranchi.Plant or plant part their commam name, scientific name, and their uses against skin disease are given below in tabular form.

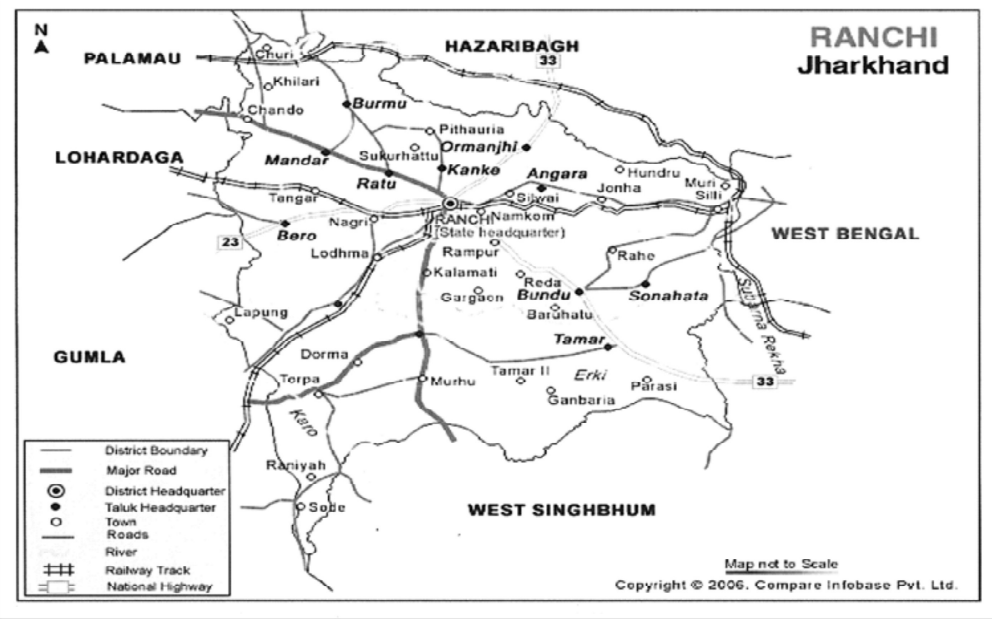


Table:Documentation ofEthnomedicinal plants of skin disease in Ranchi district.

SL. No	Plant common name	Scientific name	Family	Habit	Plant part used	Skin problem
1.	Lahsun	*Allium sativum*	Liliaceae	Herbs	Cloves paste with salt	Treat ringworm
2.	Neem	*Azadiractaindica*	Meliaceae	Tree	Bark,Leaf, Fruit	Leprosy, Scabis, skin disease.
3.	Pricly	*Argemonemexicana*	Papaveraceae	Herb	Leaf,Seed, latex,Root	Ringworm, Eczema,Scabis.
4.	Cholai	*Amaranthusspinosus*	Amaranthaceae	Herb	Leafjuice with turmeric powder	Pimples, Itching.
5.	Kachnar	*Bauhinia veriegata L.*	Caesalpiniaceae	Tree	Bark	Leprosy,Skin disease.
6.	Madar	*Calotropisprocera*	Asclepiadaceae	Shrub	Latex,Bark, Leaf	Skin infection, Ringworm.
7.	Sarso	*Brassica oleracea L.*	Bracecaceae	Herb	Leaf	Open wound.
8.	Babul	*Acatianilotica*	Mimoceae	Tree	Bark,Gum	Skin disease.
9.	Papita	*Carica papaya L.*	Caricaceae	Shrub	Latex	Ringworm, Itching.
10.	Gajar	*Daucuscarota*	Umbellifereae	Herb	Rootpaste with honey	Pimple.
11.	Datiwan	*Achyranthesaspera L.*	Lguminoceae	Shrub	Root juice	Ringworm.

Table continued..

12.	Ratti	*Abrusprecatories L.*	Leguminoceae	Shrub	Rootjuice with Lehsunjuice	Ringworms, Spots.
13.	Moongphali(peanut)	*Arachis hypogeal L.*	Fabaceae	Herb	Seedpastewith honey	Dry skin.
14.	Tamatar	*Lycopersiconesculentum L.*	Solanaceae	Herb	Fruitjuice with milk	Sunburn.
15.	Pudina	*Menthapiperita*	Labiateae	Herb	LeafJuice	Pimples.
16.	Sal	*Shorearobusta*	Dipterocar-paceae	Tree	Bark,Rasin.	Tumour,Small pox,Wounds, Sores.
17.	Arjuna	*Terminaliaarjuna(Roxb.exDC)*	Combretaceae	Tree	Bark,Leaf	Wounds.
18.	Grit kumari	*Aloe vera L.*	Liliaceae	Herb	Stem, Latex	Skin tonic , Eczema.
19.	Tulsi	*Ocimum sanctum L.*	Labiaceae	Herb	Leafpaste with lime	Ringworm
20.	Kapur	*Comphoraofficinarum*		Shrub	Distillation of tree wood	Eczema, skin disease.
21.	Haldi	*Curcuma angustifolia*	Zingiberaceae	Rhizome	Rhizome paste with neem leaf powder	Ringworm.
22.	Punvad	*Cassia tora*	Caesalpiniaceae	Shrub	Seedpaste	Ringworm,Scabies, skin disorders.
23.	Imli	*Tamarindusindica L.*	Annonaceae	Tree	Leaf, Bark	Skin disease.
24.	Datura	*Daturafustuosa*	Solanaceae	Shrub	Leaf juice with rhizome curcuma longa	Microbial infection.
25.	Kaner	*Neriumindicum*	Apocyanaceae	Shrub	Leaf, Bark, Root	Skin disease.
26.	Palas	*Buteamonosperma*	Fabaceae	Tree	Seed Paste, Flower	Ringworm.
27.	Nimbu	*Citrus bergamia L.*	Citraceae	Shrub	Seedoil with comphor	Skin disease.
28.	Khair	*Acacia catechu*	Mimosaceae	Tree	Bark paste	Skin disease.
29.	Nariyal	*Coccusnucifera*		Tree	Oil	Dermatophytes,Ring worm.
30.	Mehendi	*Lawsoniainermis Linn.*	Lythraceae	Shrub	Leaf paste with mustard oil	Skin infection.
31.	Karanj	*Pongamiapinnata*	Fabaceae	Shrub	Seed oil	Eczema, Skin infection.
32.	Makoi	*Piper nigrum*	Solanaceae	Herb	Leaf paste	Ringworm.
33.	Latjirachirchiri	*Achyranthusaspera*	Amaranthaceae	Herb	Leaf	Leprosy.
34.	Kasongi	*Cassia occidentalis*	Leguminoceae	Shrub	Seed, Bark.	White leprosy.
35.	Ashwagandha	*Withaniasominifera*	Solanaceae	Shrub	Leaf	Skin disease, Healing of wounds.
36.	Seej	*Euphorbia neriifolia*	Euphorbiaceae	Shrub	Latex	Skin disease.
37.	Jaitun	*Oleo curopaca*	Oleaceae	Tree	oil	Pimples, Scabies.
38.	Babul	*Acacia nilotica*	Mimosaceae	Tree	Bark, gum	Skin disease.
39.	Gamhar	*GmelinaarboreaRoxb.*	Verbenaceae	Tree	leaf	Skin disease.
40.	Kalmegh	*Andrographispaniculata*	Acanthaceae	Herb	Leaf	Skin disease.
41.	Badam	*Terminaliacattapa L.*	Combrataceae	Tree	Leaf powder	Itching , Rashes.

RESULT AND DISCUSSION

About 41 plants are used to cure skin disease among tribals as medicine in Ranchi district .The traditional knowledge about medicinal use of these plants becoming endangered due to various reasons like deforestation , urbanization etc. Hence following measures should be taken in account:—

(1) Investigation related to taxonomy, chemical screening and documentation of the useful species and their habitats[2,7.]

(2) Initiation of conservation by involving local participation.

(3) Implementation ofawareness activities with sustainable development.

Based on above discussion and findings it can be concluded that the herbal medicine have great potentiality to cure different kinds of skin diseases[2,8 ,9..] Then traditional uses by indigenous rural communities are free from side effects[10].

During the field investigation it has been observed that the tribes of Ranchi (Jharkhand) plays a significant role in health care through herbal treatment based on their indigenous knowledge of herbal medicinal plants.,but establishment of modern medical facilities reduces the importance of these plants[3,10,11,12,13.]

These formulations used by tribals need further clinical trials to test their efficacy in to develop new drugs based on herbal medicine for effective remedy of different ailments [14.]

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